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| 18.              | 25CV3256 | WELLS FARGO BANK, N.A. VS. STEVE ECKLAND, AN INDIVIDUAL |
| SUMMARY JUDGMENT |          |                                                         |

Plaintiff, Wells Fargo Bank, N.A. (“Plaintiff”), filed this Motion for Summary Judgment on April 15, 2026. No opposition has been filed.

### Legal Principles

[S]ummary judgment or summary adjudication is to be granted when there is no triable issue of material fact and the moving party is entitled to judgment as a matter of law.” (*Mills v. U.S. Bank* (2008) 166 Cal.App.4th 871, 894–895, 83 Cal.Rptr.3d 146.) The “party moving for summary judgment bears an initial burden of production to make a prima facie showing of the nonexistence of any triable issue of material fact; if he carries his burden of production, he causes a shift, and the opposing party is then subjected to a burden of production of his own to make a prima facie showing of the existence of a triable issue of material fact.” (*Aguilar v. Atlantic Richfield Co.* (2001) 25 Cal.4th 826, 861–862, 107 Cal.Rptr.2d 841, 24 P.3d 493.)

In *Thatcher v. Lucky Stores, Inc.* (2000) 79 Cal.App.4th 1081, 1084, 94 Cal.Rptr.2d 575, a trial court granted summary judgment to defendant because plaintiffs failed to file any opposition, pursuant to a local court rule providing that the failure to oppose a motion may be deemed an admission that the motion is meritorious. **On appeal, the local rule was held invalid because it conflicted with Code of Civil Procedure section 437c by authorizing the trial court “to grant summary judgment based solely on the absence of opposition, without a preliminary finding that the moving party has met its initial burden of proof.”** (*Thatcher v. Lucky Stores, Inc., supra*, at pp. 1086–1087, 94 Cal.Rptr.2d 575.) The *Thatcher* court emphasized that the statute requires that the moving party assume the initial burden of producing evidence that no triable issue of material fact exists. (*Id.* at p. 1085, 94 Cal.Rptr.2d 575.) *Boyle v. CertainTeed Corp.*, 137 Cal. App. 4th 645, 654, 40 Cal. Rptr. 3d 501, 508 (2006)

Under summary judgment law, any party to an action, whether plaintiff or defendant, “may move” the court “for summary judgment” in his favor on a cause of action (i.e., claim) or defense (Code Civ. Proc., § 437c, subd. (a))—a plaintiff “contend[ing] ... that there is no defense to the action,” a defendant “contend[ing] that the action has no merit” (*ibid.*). The court must “grant[]” the “motion” “if all the papers submitted show” that “there is no triable issue as to any material fact” (*id.*, § 437c, subd. (c))—that is, there is no issue requiring a trial as to any fact that is necessary under the pleadings and, ultimately, the law (see *Riverside County Community Facilities Dist. v. Bainbridge* 17 (1999) 77 Cal.App.4th 644, 653 [92 Cal.Rptr.2d 29]; *Kelly v. First Astri Corp.* (1999) 72 Cal.App.4th 462, 470 [84 Cal.Rptr.2d 810])—and that the “moving party is entitled to a judgment as a matter of law” (Code Civ. Proc., § 437c, subd. (c)). The moving party must “support[]” the “motion” with evidence including “affidavits, declarations, admissions,

answers to interrogatories, depositions, and matters of which judicial notice” must or may “be taken.” (*Id.*, § 437c, subd. (b).)

Likewise, any adverse party may oppose the motion, and, “where appropriate,” must present evidence including “affidavits, declarations, admissions, answers to interrogatories, depositions, and matters of which judicial notice” must or may “be taken.” (*Ibid.*) An adverse party who chooses to oppose the motion must be allowed a reasonable opportunity to do so. (*Id.*, § 437c, subd. (h).) In ruling on the motion, the court must “consider all of the evidence” and “all” of the “inferences” reasonably drawn therefrom (*id.*, § 437c, subd. (c)), and must view such evidence (e.g., *Molko v. Holy Spirit Assn.*, *supra*, 46 Cal.3d at p. 1107; *Stationers Corp. v. Dun & Bradstreet, Inc.* (1965) 62 Cal.2d 412, 417 [42 Cal.Rptr. 449, 398 P.2d 785]) and such inferences (see, e.g., *Crouse v. Brobeck, Phleger & Harrison* (1998) 67 Cal.App.4th 1509, 1520 [80 Cal.Rptr.2d 94] [review on appeal]; *Ales-Peratis Foods Internat., Inc. v. American Can Co.* (1985) 164 Cal.App.3d 277, 280, fn. \* [209 Cal.Rptr. 917] [same]), in the light most favorable to the opposing party. *Aguilar v. Atl. Richfield Co.*, 25 Cal. 4th 826, 843, 24 P.3d 493 (2001), as modified (July 11, 2001).

### **Background**

On December 9, 2025, Plaintiff filed a Complaint for Breach of Contract (written) and Breach of Contract (implied in fact). Defendant, Steve Eckland (“Defendant”), filed an Answer on January 5, 2026.

### **Discussion**

Defendant applied for and was issued a Wells Fargo credit card ending in 2869. Plaintiff sent Defendant the credit card along with the written Customer Agreement associated with the credit card. Pursuant to the terms of the written Customer Agreement, Defendant accepted the terms of the written agreement when they used the Wells Fargo Credit Card.

Pursuant to the terms of the Customer Agreement associated with the card, Plaintiff would extend credit to Defendant whereby Defendant could charge goods, services, or obtain cash advances on the credit line. In exchange, Defendant was to repay the principal amount lent plus applicable interest and finance charges. In accordance with the Customer Agreement, Defendant used the account, and made payments, charges, and incurred a balance thereon. Plaintiff sent Defendant monthly statements of the Subject Account each and every billing period. Defendant’s last payment on the Subject Account was on April 9, 2025. The balance due on Defendant’s Subject Account is \$24,510.81.

The elements of a breach of a written contract are 1) existence of the contract; 2) plaintiff's performance or excuse for nonperformance; 3) defendant's breach; and (4) damages to plaintiff as a result of the breach. *Aton Center, Inc. v. United Healthcare Ins. Co.* (2023) 93

Cal.App.5th 1214, 1230. A cause of action for breach of implied contract has the same elements as does a cause of action for breach of contract, except that the promise is not expressed in words but is implied from the promisor's conduct." *Id.*

Plaintiff has established the elements of breach of written contract and implied contract. Plaintiff provided documents establishing Defendant applied for and was issued a Wells Fargo Credit Card, a Customer Agreement that incorporated the terms and conditions of the card, and monthly account statements reflecting a history of purchase and payments on the account. The evidence indicates that Plaintiff lent credit and Defendant stopped making payments on April 9, 2025, leaving a balance owed of \$24,510.81. No evidence was offered to rebut the evidence presented.

Plaintiff's Motion for Summary Judgment is granted. Judgment is entered for the Plaintiff in the amount of \$24,510.81, plus costs in the amount of \$870.00, for a total judgment of \$25,380.81.

**TENTATIVE RULING #18:**

**PLAINTIFF'S MOTION FOR SUMMARY JUDGMENT IS GRANTED. JUDGMENT IS ENTERED FOR THE PLAINTIFF IN THE AMOUNT OF \$24,510.81, PLUS COSTS IN THE AMOUNT OF \$870.00, FOR A TOTAL JUDGMENT OF \$25,380.81.**

**NO HEARING ON THIS MATTER WILL BE HELD UNLESS A REQUEST FOR ORAL ARGUMENT IS TRANSMITTED ELECTRONICALLY THROUGH THE COURT'S WEBSITE OR BY TELEPHONE TO THE COURT AT (530) 621-6551 BY 4:00 P.M. ON THE DAY THE TENTATIVE RULING IS ISSUED. CAL. RULE CT. 3.1308; LOCAL RULE 8.05.07; SEE ALSO LEWIS V. SUPERIOR COURT, 19 CAL.4TH 1232, 1247 (1999).**

**NOTICE TO ALL PARTIES OF A REQUEST FOR ORAL ARGUMENT AND THE GROUNDS UPON WHICH ARGUMENT IS BEING REQUESTED MUST BE MADE BY TELEPHONE OR IN PERSON BY 4:00 P.M. ON THE DAY THE TENTATIVE RULING IS ISSUED. CAL. RULE CT. 3.1308; EL DORADO COUNTY LOCAL RULE 8.05.07. PROOF OF SERVICE OF SAID NOTICE MUST BE FILED PRIOR TO OR AT THE HEARING.**

**LONG CAUSE HEARINGS MUST BE REQUESTED BY 4:00 P.M. ON THE DAY THE TENTATIVE RULING IS ISSUED AND THE PARTIES ARE TO PROVIDE THE COURT WITH THREE MUTUALLY AGREEABLE DATES ON FRIDAY AFTERNOONS AT 2:30 P.M. LONG CAUSE ORAL ARGUMENT REQUESTS WILL BE SET FOR HEARING ON ONE OF THE THREE MUTUALLY AGREEABLE DATES ON FRIDAY AFTERNOONS AT 2:30 P.M. THE COURT WILL ADVISE THE PARTIES OF THE LONG CAUSE HEARING DATE AND TIME BY 5:00 P.M. ON THE DAY THE TENTATIVE RULING IS ISSUED. PARTIES MAY PERSONALLY APPEAR AT THE HEARING.**